Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD Applicant

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Major rank 3/87
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Summary

- EE undergrad at Tongji (rank **3/87**). Research on **multimodal AI** and **trustworthy AI**.
- Accepted papers at **IJCAI**, **IJCNN**, **ICANN**; submissions to **ACM MM** and **NeurIPS**.

Education

B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.

Research

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Distill multiple clinical models into one small model without inheriting each teacher's bias.

Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization — ACM MM 2026
C. Chen* et al. **Under review; co-first. Initial score 4/4/4/4/3.**
Locate audio-visual events from any text query, with reliability-aware distillation.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Describe scenes in symbols so text-only LLMs can reason about images.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Plan retrieval under a fixed budget, including evidence that might disagree.

Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage — NeurIPS 2026
C. Chen et al. **Under review; first author.**
Flag risky neural-operator outputs in one forward pass.

Awards

Provincial First Prize, China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition	2026
National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition	2025
National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition	2025
Provincial Second Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC)	2024
Provincial Second Prize, National College Student Mathematics Competition (CMC)	2025

Skills

- **Experience:** Familiar with common research workflows and tools, including **Python**, **PyTorch**, **Git**, **LaTeX**, experiment tracking, and LLM/agent prototyping for literature review, coding, and analysis.
- **Writing:** English level sufficient to read and understand research papers; familiar with the focus, process, and logic of both academic writing and project writing.
- **Passion:** Genuinely enthusiastic about learning and exploration, and eager to push into areas I have not worked in yet.